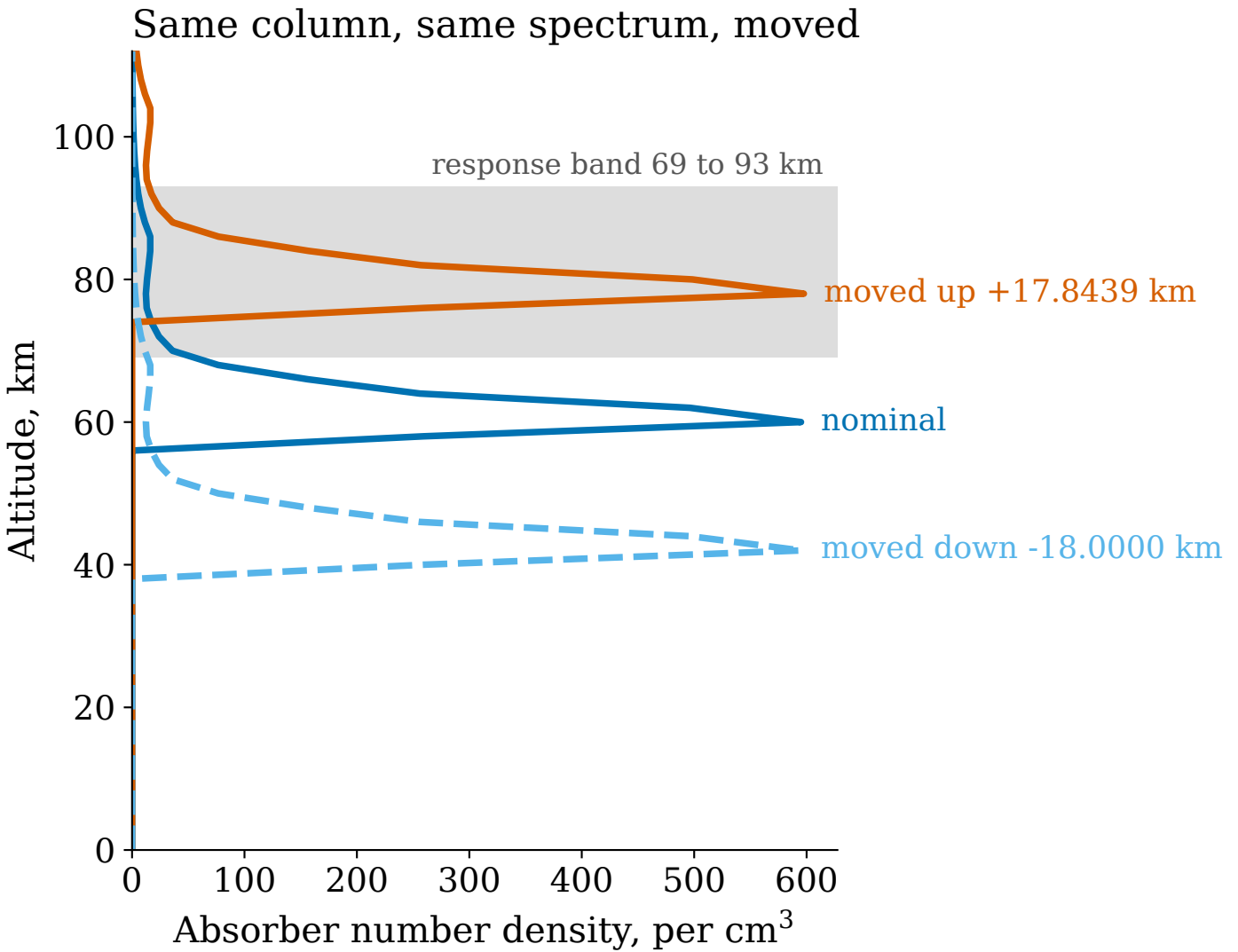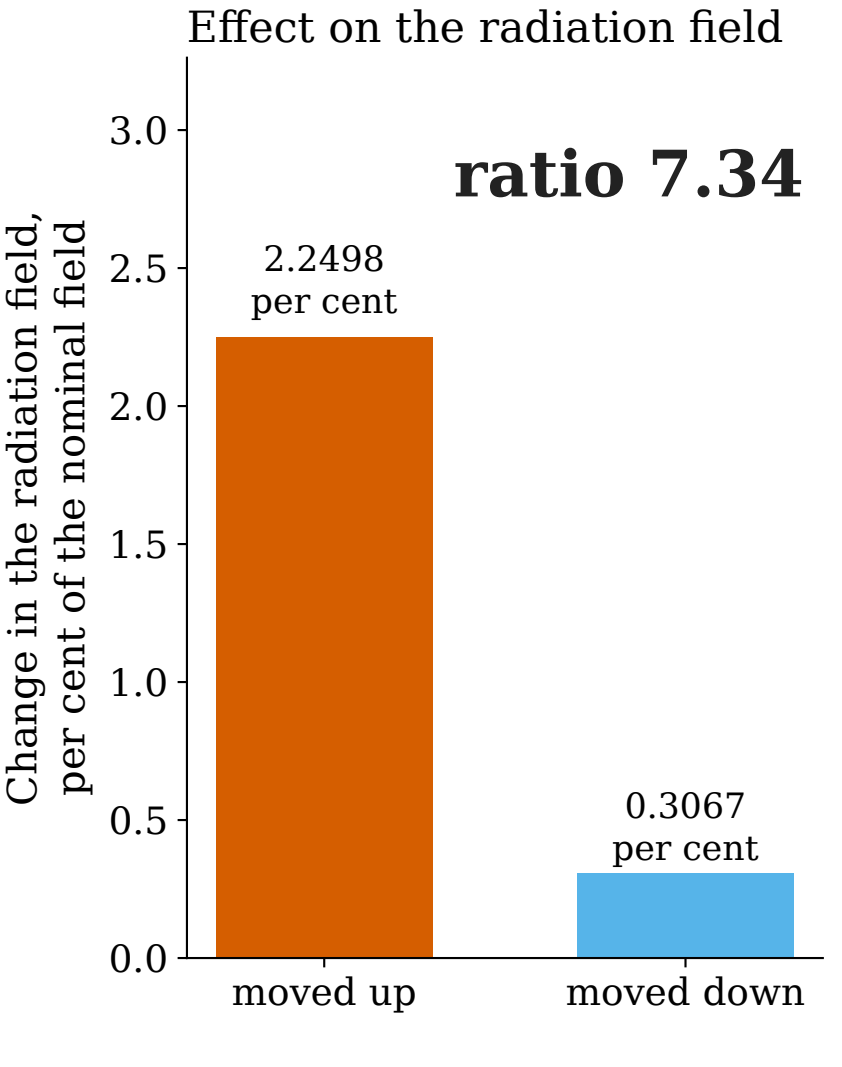Where the absorber sits matters more than anything else tested